Spring Framework is the core of the Spring platform, the project that started it all. It supports dependency injection, transaction management, data access, messaging, web applications, and more. The framework establishes the "plumbing" of enterprise applications so you can focus on the business logic.

Spring Framework provides an execution context (called *Spring context* or *container*), where beans, properties, and resources are managed throughout the entire application life cycle. I'll assume you are already familiar with the framework's core features, so I will not spend too much time on it. In particular, you should be aware of the Spring context's role and be comfortable working with Spring beans, annotation-based configuration, and dependency injection. We will rely on those features, so you should have them sorted out.

Based on the framework, *Spring Boot* makes it possible to build standalone, production-ready applications quickly. Spring Boot takes an opinionated view of Spring and third-party libraries, and it comes bundled with a sensible default configuration that lets developers get started with minimal up-front work while still providing full customization possibilities.

Throughout this book, you'll have a chance to use several Spring projects to implement patterns and best practices for cloud native applications, including Spring Boot, Spring Cloud, Spring Data, Spring Security, Spring Session, and Spring Native.

NOTE If you are interested in learning more about the core Spring features, you can find a few books on the subject in the Manning catalog, including *Spring Start Here* by Laurențiu Spilcă (Manning, 2021) and *Spring in Action*, sixth edition, by Craig Walls (Manning, 2022). You can also refer to *Spring Boot: Up & Running* by Mark Heckler (O'Reilly, 2021).

2.2.2 Building a Spring Boot application